



RTR' (RADIO TELEPHONY)

QUESTION BANK

DGCA
UPDATE 2.0



1. Q1. What is the maximum penalty for unauthorized use of radio communication equipment, as per the Indian Telegraph Act, 1885?

- (A) Fine up to \$1,000
- (B) Imprisonment for up to 6 months or fine, or both.
- (C) **Imprisonment for up to 3 years or fine, or both.**
- (D) Suspension of the pilot's license only.



Correct Answer: C) Imprisonment for up to 3 years or fine, or both.

2. Q2. What is the full pronunciation for the number 5 when transmitting a series of digits in aeronautical mobile service communications?

- (A) FIVE
- (B) **FIFE**
- (C) FIV
- (D) FIVVE



Correct Answer: B) FIFE

3. Q3. The time transmitted in the aeronautical mobile service should be given to the nearest:

- (A) Hour
- (B) 10 minutes
- (C) **Minute**
- (D) Second



Correct Answer: C) Minute

4. Q4. The call sign of the ground station should normally appear at which point in a routine communication initiated by the aircraft?

- (A) It is stated only at the end of the transmission.
- (B) It is stated immediately following the aircraft's own call sign.
- (C) **It is stated first, before the aircraft's own call sign.**
- (D) It is stated only if the ground station is requested to respond.



Correct Answer: C) It is stated first, before the aircraft's own call sign.

5. Q5. Which of the following is the standard phraseology for saying 'Yes' or 'That is correct'?

- (A) ROGER
- (B) CONFIRM
- (C) **AFFIRM**
- (D) ACKNOWLEDGE



Correct Answer: C) AFFIRM

6. Q6. The distress signal 'MAYDAY' must be preceded by which alerting call?

- (A) PAN-PAN (three times)
- (B) MAYDAY RELAY (three times)
- (C) SECURITÉ (three times)
- (D) **MAYDAY (three times)**



Correct Answer: D) MAYDAY (three times)

7. Q7. What is the ICAO standard pronunciation for the digit 9?

- (A) NINE
- (B) **NINER**
- (C) NINAH
- (D) NIGHT



Correct Answer: B) NINER

8. Q8. A clearance given by an ATC unit should normally be read back in full by the pilot, except for which type of clearance?

- (A) Frequency change instructions.
- (B) Taxi instructions.
- (C) Standard instrument departure (SID) name.
- (D) **Altitude and flight level instructions are always mandatory readback items.**



Correct Answer: D) Altitude and flight level instructions are always mandatory readback items.

9. Q9. Which Q-code is used by the ground station to ask the aircraft: 'What is my true bearing from you?'

- (A) QDM
- (B) **QTE**
- (C) QDR
- (D) QUJ



Correct Answer: B) QTE



KEY TAKEAWAY

- ✓ Use correct phraseology for clarity.
- ✓ Pronunciations (e.g., FIFE, NINER) are critical.
- ✓ MAYDAY is for life-threatening emergencies only.
- ✓ Readback is essential – follow exceptions.
- ✓ Q-codes help in precise questioning.

REMEMBER





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- 10.** What is the primary action required by a pilot who hears an urgency call (PAN-PAN) on the frequency?

- (A) Immediately change frequency to clear the channel
- (B) Continue routine transmission, as it is only an urgency call.
- (C) Acknowledge the call immediately.
- (D) Cease any transmission likely to interfere with the urgency communication.



Correct Answer: D) Cease any transmission likely to interfere with the urgency communication.

- 11.** In the event of a total communication failure (radio failure) on an IFR flight, the pilot should first set the transponder to which emergency code?

- (A) 7500
- (B) **7600**
- (C) 7700
- (D) 2000



Correct Answer: B) 7600

- 12.** What is the recommended range of speech rate (words per minute) for routine radio communication?

- (A) 50 to 80 words per minute
- (B) **80 to 120 words per minute**
- (C) 120 to 150 words per minute
- (D) As fast as possible to minimize channel occupancy.



Correct Answer: B) 80 to 120 words per minute

- 13.** What is the correct way to express the time 0930 Coordinated Universal Time (UTC) to a ground station?

- (A) ZERO NINER THREE ZERO ZULU
- (B) ZERO NINER THREE ZERO HOURS
- (C) **TIME ZERO NINER THREE ZERO**
- (D) NINER THIRTY ZULU



Correct Answer: C) TIME ZERO NINER THREE ZERO

- 14.** Which frequency band is primarily used for long-distance, high-frequency (HF) aeronautical communications?

- (A) VHF (Very High Frequency)
- (B) UHF (Ultra High Frequency)
- (C) **HF (High Frequency)**
- (D) MF (Medium Frequency)



Correct Answer: C) HF (High Frequency)

- 15.** What is the correct phraseology for requesting the magnetic heading to be flown to reach the station?

- (A) REQUEST QDR
- (B) **REQUEST QDM**
- (C) REQUEST QNH
- (D) REQUEST HEADING



Correct Answer: B) REQUEST QDM

- 16.** When an aircraft's assigned altitude or flight level is not to be read back, what phraseology should the controller use?

- (A) ROGER
- (B) **READBACK NOT REQUIRED**
- (C) CONFIRM RECEIPT ONLY
- (D) Altitude and flight level instructions are always mandatory readback items.



Correct Answer: B) READBACK NOT REQUIRED

- 17.** The transmission of the distress message (MAYDAY message) should contain which three mandatory pieces of information, immediately after the distress signal?

- (A) Aircraft color, number of people on board, and destination.
- (B) Position, nature of distress, and pilot's name.
- (C) **Aircraft call sign, position, and nature of distress.**
- (D) Fuel remaining, intentions, and nearest airport.

Correct Answer: C) Aircraft call sign, position, and nature of distress.

MAYDAY



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18. What is the standard ICAO phonetic word for the letter 'X'?

- (A) X-ya
- (B) **X-ray**
- (C) Xylophone
- (D) Extra



Correct Answer: B) X-ray

19. The procedural word (proword) used by an ATC unit to indicate a mistake has been made in the transmission and that the corrected version will follow immediately is:

- (A) NEGAT
- (B) **CORRECTION**
- (C) ERROR
- (D) DISREGARD



Correct Answer: B) CORRECTION

20. What is the maximum effective communication range of standard VHF (Very High Frequency) air-ground communication, which is essentially line-of-sight?

- (A) 50 nautical miles (NM)
- (B) **Approximately 200 nautical miles (NM) at high altitudes.**
- (C) 2,000 nautical miles (NM)
- (D) Limited to 5 nautical miles regardless of altitude.



Correct Answer: B) Approximately 200 nautical miles (NM) at high altitudes.

21. Which procedural word is used to request permission for the intended action?

- (A) REQUEST
- (B) CLEARED
- (C) PERMIT
- (D) **PROCEED**



Correct Answer: D) PROCEED

22. The proword 'I SAY AGAIN' should be used when:

- (A) The message being sent is extremely important.
- (B) **The sender is repeating a specific part of the message for clarity.**
- (C) The receiving station requested a repeat using 'SAY AGAIN'.
- (D) The aircraft is changing from VFR to IFR.



Correct Answer: B) The sender is repeating a specific part of the message for clarity.

23. What is the standard phraseology for expressing visibility of 10 kilometres or more?

- (A) VISIBILITY ONE ZERO KILOMETRES
- (B) VISIBILITY ONE ZERO PLUS
- (C) VISIBILITY ONE ZERO
- (D) **VISIBILITY TEN KILOMETRES OR MORE or VISIBILITY MORE THAN NINE KILOMETRES**



Correct Answer: D) VISIBILITY TEN KILOMETRES OR MORE or VISIBILITY MORE THAN NINE KILOMETRES

24. Which of the following is the correct radiotelephony procedure for establishing initial contact with an ATC unit?

- (A) Aircraft call sign, followed by the ground station call sign and current altitude.
- (B) **Ground station call sign, followed by the aircraft call sign, then position, time, and level/altitude.**
- (C) Aircraft call sign only, followed by 'CHECKING IN'.
- (D) Ground station call sign, then request for frequency change.

Correct Answer: B) Ground station call sign, followed by the aircraft call sign, then position, time, and level/altitude.



KEY TAKEAWAY

- ✓ Know ICAO phonetic alphabet well.
- ✓ Use correct procedural words for clarity.
- ✓ Understand VHF communication limits.
- ✓ Follow standard phraseology for visibility & urgency.
- ✓ Correct radiotelephony procedure ensures safe communication.

REMEMBER

- ✓ X = X-ray
- ✓ Mistake in transmission? Use CORRECTION.
- ✓ VHF range ≈ 200 NM at high altitudes.
- ✓ Permission request? Use PROCEED.
- ✓ Repeating part of message? Use I SAY AGAIN.





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25. The Q-code QFE is used for setting the altimeter to read:

- (A) Altitude above Mean Sea Level (MSL).
- (B) Pressure altitude (standard pressure 1013.2 hPa).
- (C) **Height above the aerodrome elevation (Zero on the ground at the field reference point).**
- (D) True air speed.



Correct Answer: C) Height above the aerodrome elevation (Zero on the ground at the field reference point).

26. If an ATC unit transmits 'PASS YOUR MESSAGE', what does this request imply?

- (A) The aircraft should now change frequency.
- (B) **The controller is ready to receive the full content of the previous transmission.**
- (C) The aircraft should stand by and wait for instructions.
- (D) The aircraft should pass a message to another aircraft.

**PASS
YOUR
MESSAGE**

Correct Answer: B) The controller is ready to receive the full content of the previous transmission.

27. The safety signal SECURITÉ (spoken three times) has priority over which other class of message?

- (A) Distress messages (MAYDAY)
- (B) Urgency messages (PAN-PAN)
- (C) **All other communications except distress and urgency.**
- (D) All other transmissions on the channel.



**SECURITÉ
SECURITÉ
SECURITÉ**

Correct Answer: C) All other communications except distress and urgency.

28. What is the standard ICAO phonetic word for the number 3?

- (A) THREE
- (B) TREE
- (C) THREE-E
- (D) **TREE**



Correct Answer: D) TREE

29. If a pilot has been instructed to 'REPORT PASSING [FIX]', what is the primary purpose of this instruction?

- (A) To notify the controller that the aircraft is performing a holding procedure.
- (B) To request permission to proceed to the next waypoint.
- (C) **To allow the controller to confirm the aircraft's position and verify the navigation performance.**
- (D) To request a change in the flight path.



Correct Answer: C) To allow the controller to confirm the aircraft's position and verify the navigation performance.

30. Which procedural word (proword) is used by a ground station to indicate that the aircraft is authorized to proceed under the conditions specified?

- (A) STANDBY
- (B) **PROCEED**
- (C) ROGER
- (D) AFFIRM



Correct Answer: B) PROCEED

KEY TAKEAWAY

- ✓ QFE = Height above aerodrome elevation.
- ✓ 'PASS YOUR MESSAGE' = Controller ready for full message.
- ✓ SECURITÉ (x3) has priority over all other communications except distress and urgency.
- ✓ Use correct ICAO phonetics (e.g., 3 = TREE).
- ✓ 'REPORT PASSING [FIX]' helps controller verify position.
- ✓ 'PROCEED' = Cleared to continue as instructed.

REMEMBER

- ✓ Understand Q-codes.
- ✓ Know prowords & their meanings.
- ✓ Follow phraseology for safe & effective radio communication.
- ✓ Clarity, brevity & readback are key.





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1. What is the correct phraseology a pilot should use to request to change frequency from the current controlling agency to another?

- (A) CHANGE TO NEW FREQUENCY
- (B) REQUEST CONTACT
- (C) SWITCH TO [FREQUENCY]
- (D) CONTACT [CONTROL UNIT] [FREQUENCY]



Correct Answer: D) CONTACT [CONTROL UNIT] [FREQUENCY]

2. The phonetic spelling for the letter "V" in the ICAO phonetic alphabet is:

- (A) Vessel
- (B) Volta
- (C) Very
- (D) Victor



Correct Answer: D) Victor

3. What is the proper phraseology for transmitting the number '10,000' feet in a standard radio communication?

- (A) TEN THOUSAND
- (B) ONE ZERO ZERO ZERO FEET
- (C) ONE ZERO THOUSAND FEET
- (D) ONE ZERO THOUSAND



Correct Answer: D) ONE ZERO THOUSAND

4. When a radiotelephone operator is told to 'STANDBY', what is the expected action?

- (A) Immediately change frequency as instructed.
- (B) End the transmission with 'OUT' and await further instructions.
- (C) Wait for a short but unspecified period for a reply.
- (D) Repeat the last transmission for confirmation.



Correct Answer: C) Wait for a short but unspecified period for a reply.

5. What is the minimum required signal strength (readability) for a successful two-way radiotelephone communication in the aeronautical mobile service?

- (A) Readability 1 (Unreadable)
- (B) Readability 2 (Readable now and then)
- (C) Readability 3 (Readable, but with difficulty)
- (D) Readability 5 (Perfectly readable)



Correct Answer: C) Readability 3 (Readable, but with difficulty)

6. What Q-code is used to request the magnetic bearing from the station to the aircraft?

- (A) QDM
- (B) QDR
- (C) QTE
- (D) QFU



Correct Answer: B) QDR

7. In a situation involving a fire onboard the aircraft that is NOT immediately life-threatening but requires urgent action, which signal should the pilot transmit before the message?

- (A) MAYDAY
- (B) EMERGENCY
- (C) PAN-PAN
- (D) SECURITÉ



Correct Answer: C) PAN-PAN

8. How are flight levels (FLs) above the Transition Altitude normally transmitted by radio?

- (A) In feet above mean sea level (MSL).
- (B) As the full number followed by 'THOUSAND FEET'.
- (C) In metres above mean sea level (MSL).
- (D) As the number of hundreds of feet, spoken as individual digits, followed by the word 'FLIGHT LEVEL'.



Correct Answer: D) As the number of hundreds of feet, spoken as individual digits, followed by the word 'FLIGHT LEVEL'.

9. If a ground station sends a message and receives no reply, what is the maximum number of times it may repeat the call sign of the station called, before giving the message "TO ALL STATIONS"?

- (A) Once
- (B) Twice
- (C) Three times

Correct Answer: C) Three times



KEY TAKEAWAY

- Use correct phraseology & Q-codes.
- Phonetics ensure clear communication.
- Readability 3 is the minimum for two-way communication.
- PAN-PAN for urgent but not life-threatening situations.
- FL transmission above TA = Hundreds of feet + FLIGHT LEVEL.

REMEMBER

- QFE = Aerodrome elevation (Zero at field reference).
- STANDBY = Wait briefly for reply.
- CONTACT [UNIT] [FREQUENCY] for frequency change.
- TO ALL STATIONS after 3 unanswered calls.





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1. What is the correct phraseology to indicate that the entire last message has been received and understood, and the instruction contained therein will be executed.

- (A) ROGER
- (B) AFFIRM
- (C) WILCO
- (D) OUT



Correct Answer: C) WILCO

2. The distress signal MAYDAY, when spoken three times, indicates what level of urgency for the aircraft and its occupants?

- (A) An urgent situation concerning the safety of an aircraft or other vehicle, or of some person on board or in sight.
- (B) A minor technical fault that requires attention but is not immediately life-threatening.
- (C) The aircraft is threatened by grave and imminent danger and requires immediate assistance.
- (D) A practice emergency procedure for training purposes.



Correct Answer: C) The aircraft is threatened by grave and imminent danger and requires immediate assistance.

3. What is the correct meaning of the Q-code QNH?

- (A) The atmospheric pressure at aerodrome elevation.
- (B) The atmospheric pressure at mean sea level (MSL) used for setting the altimeter to indicate elevation above MSL.
- (C) The magnetic bearing from the station to the aircraft.
- (D) The true bearing from the aircraft to the station.

Correct Answer: B) The atmospheric pressure at mean sea level (MSL) used for setting the altimeter to indicate elevation above MSL.



4. According to the standard readability scale used in aeronautical radio communication, which rating signifies 'Readability poor'?

- (A) Readability 1
- (B) Readability 2
- (C) Readability 3
- (D) Readability 4



Correct Answer: C) Readability 3

5. What time standard is mandatory for use in all aeronautical mobile service communications?

- (A) Local Time, specified by the controlling station.
- (B) Coordinated Universal Time (UTC), often referred to as "Zulu" time.
- (C) Greenwich Mean Time (GMT).
- (D) Daylight Saving Time (DST) of the departure aerodrome.



Correct Answer: B) Coordinated Universal Time (UTC), often referred to as 'Zulu' time.

6. Which procedural word (proword) is used by a radiotelephone operator to indicate that a separation is made between portions of a message?

- (A) OVER
- (B) BREAK
- (C) STANDBY
- (D) SAY AGAIN



Correct Answer: B) BREAK

7. What is the highest precedence category for a message transmitted in the aeronautical mobile service?

- (A) Urgency messages, such as those concerning serious technical difficulties.
- (B) Safety messages, such as those relating to important flight conditions.
- (C) Distress messages, indicated by MAYDAY.
- (D) Flight safety messages, such as Air Traffic Control clearances.



Correct Answer: C) Distress messages, indicated by MAYDAY.

8. When an Air Traffic Control (ATC) unit needs to cancel a previously issued clearance, which proword should they use to introduce the cancellation?

- (A) DISREGARD
- (B) CANCEL
- (C) NEGATIVE
- (D) CORRECTION



Correct Answer: B) CANCEL

9. What is the proper phraseology for transmitting the number '10,000' feet in a standard radio communication?

- (A) TEN THOUSAND
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- (C) ONE ZERO THOUSAND FEET
- (D) ONE ZERO THOUSAND



Correct Answer: D) ONE ZERO THOUSAND

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- (A) QDM
- (B) QDR
- (C) QTE
- (D) QFU



Correct Answer: B) QDR



KEY TAKEAWAY

- ✓ WILCO = Will comply.
- ✓ MAYDAY (x3) = Grave & imminent danger.
- ✓ QNH = Pressure at MSL for altimeter setting.
- ✓ Readability 3 = Poor readability.
- ✓ UTC (Zulu time) = Mandatory time standard.

REMEMBER

- ✓ BREAK = Separation between parts of a message.
- ✓ Distress messages (MAYDAY) have the highest precedence.
- ✓ Use correct phraseology & Q-codes for clear communication.
- ✓ Readability impacts safety – speak clearly!

